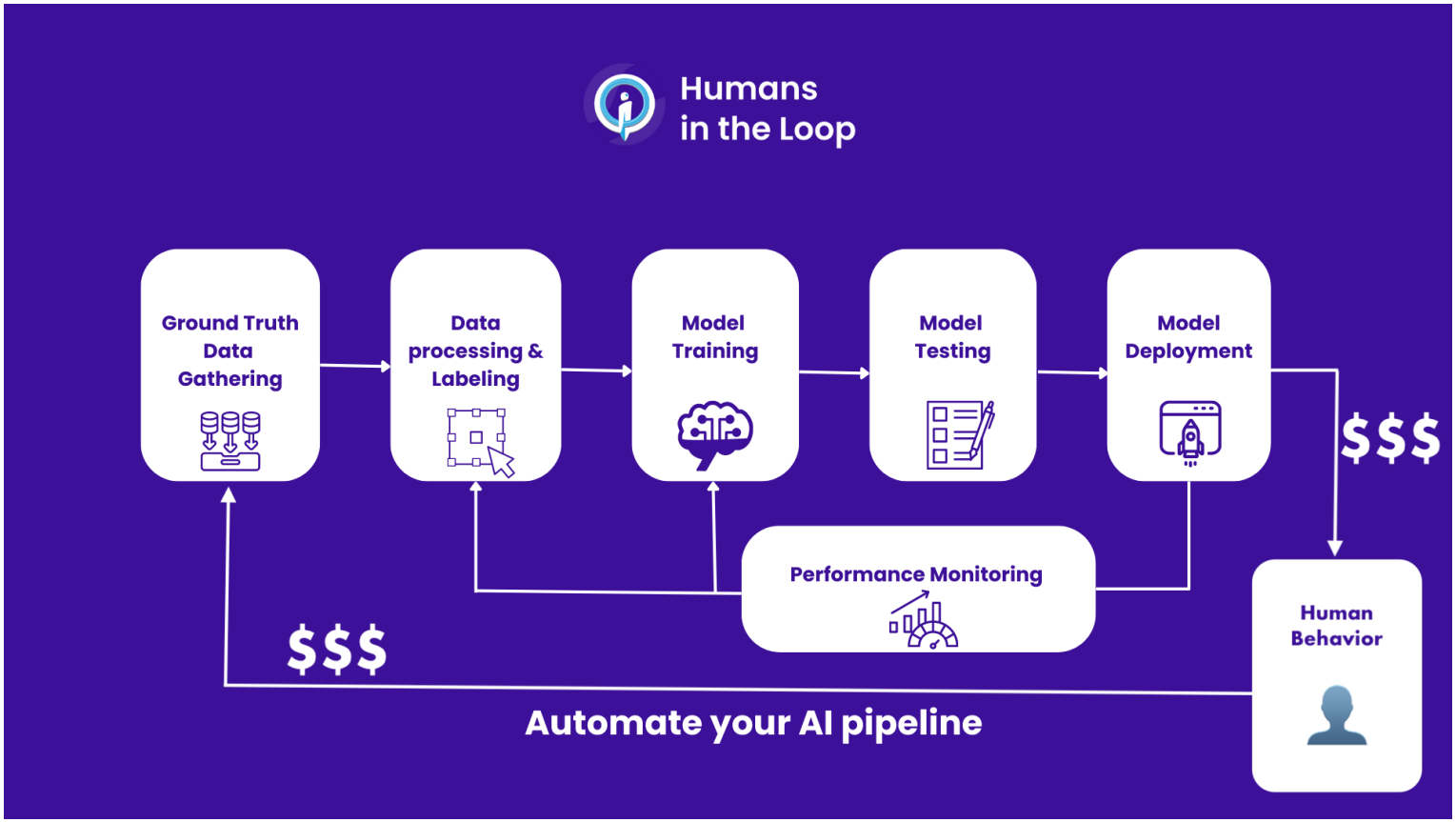
PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Christopher Zorn

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Back to Data


Humans
in the Loop
Ground Truth
Data
Gathering
Data
processing &
Labeling
Model
Training
Model
Testing
Model
Deployment
$$$
Performance Monitoring
Human
Behavior
$$$
Automate your AI pipeline

"Surveillance Capitalism"

Zuboff (*The Age of Surveillance Capitalism*, 2019):

- **Behavioral Surplus**
  - The platform's user/pipeline data beyond functional necessity
  - Example: A "smart" thermostat (e.g., Google Nest)
- **Prediction Products**
  - Outputs built from behavioral data that forecast individual/group behavior
  - Example: Targeted advertising auctions
- **Behavioral Futures Markets**
  - The marketplaces where predictions about human behavior are bought and sold
  - Example: Real-time digital ad exchanges

Note: This is not a "bug."

Case Study: Cambridge Analytica

What happened:

- 2013: University of Cambridge psychometrics / personality quiz $\rightarrow$ Facebook $\rightarrow$ 350k responses
- FB's pre-2015 Open Graph API allowed access to friends' data w/o consent
- Result: 350,000 quiz-takers $\rightarrow$ 87 million Facebook profiles
- Cambridge Analytica combined it with voter rolls, purchase histories, browsing data, and more
- Yield: 5,000+ data points on 230 million US adults
- $\rightarrow$ psychological profiles and micro-targeting of individual voters with messages calibrated to their personality profile
- CA used this for Trump + Cruz in 2016 "to identify the specific individuals in specific states who could be moved, either to activate or depress their turnout"

Case Study: Cambridge Analytica



Consequences:

- March 17, 2018: Stories in the *NYT & Guardian*
- By March 26, FB had lost $100m in market cap; stock fell by 24% ($\approx$ $134b)
- April 2018: Senate Judiciary hearings
- July 2018: UK fined FB £500k
- July 2019: FTC fined FB $5b + SEC fined FB $100m
- `#DeleteFacebook` movement

Itoi (2025)

Data Privacy Practice	Amazon	Anthropic	Google	Meta	Microsoft	OpenAI
Chat input used for training by default	Not Specified	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Mechanism to opt out of chat training	Not Specified	Yes	Yes	Not Specified	Yes	Yes
Chat data retained indefinitely	Yes	No	No	Yes	No	Yes
Chatbot personalization features	Not Specified	Not Specified	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Allows accounts for children 13-18	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Cause for concern?

- All six major US frontier AI developers (Amazon, Anthropic, Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI) use chat data to train their models by default
- Some allow opt-out; some do not. Some retain data indefinitely
- Multiproduct companies (Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon) merge chat data with data from other products: searches, purchases, social media engagement
- Each varies in how it treats data for those under 18

The Dinner Recipe

Example:

1. You ask a chatbot for low-sugar / heart-friendly dinner ideas
2. The chatbot "infers" you may be health-vulnerable
3. That inference propagates through the company's ecosystem
4. You start seeing medication ads, etc.
5. $\rightarrow$ your health insurance company...

Zuboff's "behavioral surplus" + "prediction futures markets" embedded in AI chat.